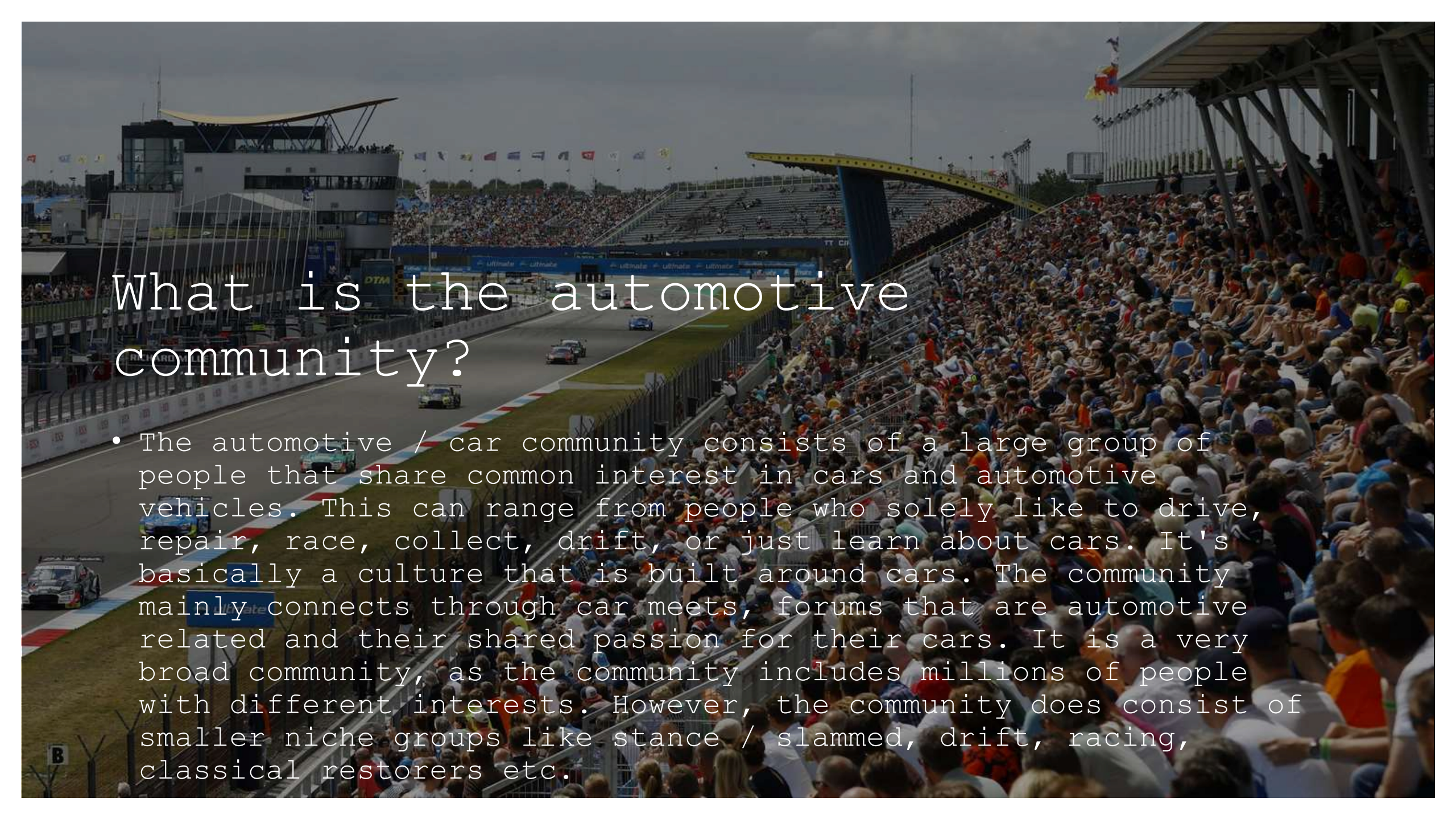




Automotive Discourse Community

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A wide-angle photograph of a motorsport event, likely a Formula 1 race, taken from an elevated position behind the track. The track is a dark asphalt surface with white and red curbing. Several race cars are visible on the track, including a prominent blue and white car in the foreground. The grandstands are filled with a large crowd of spectators, many wearing hats and casual clothing. In the background, there are various structures, including a large white building with a curved roof and several flags flying. The sky is overcast and grey.

What is the automotive community?

- The automotive / car community consists of a large group of people that share common interest in cars and automotive vehicles. This can range from people who solely like to drive, repair, race, collect, drift, or just learn about cars. It's basically a culture that is built around cars. The community mainly connects through car meets, forums that are automotive related and their shared passion for their cars. It is a very broad community, as the community includes millions of people with different interests. However, the community does consist of smaller niche groups like stance / slammed, drift, racing, classical restorers etc.

Automotive Community Within App State

- The App Auto Club is a student run organization that brings enthusiasts together from all different backgrounds and interests. The club organized events such as car meets, cruises, and campus gatherings, with some even as going as far as the Wilkesboro Dragway. These events encourage collaboration, networking, and mutual respect within the different interests of people and their cars. The club acts as a hub for car



Identifying SLR Standards

- Shared Language - The automotive community uses specific vocabulary that others outside the community or unfamiliar with cars might not understand. Things like horsepower, torque, camber, headers, boost, coils / coil overs, NA, procharged, and many more words can be listed.
- Rhetorical Standards: Members of the community have shared expectations about how others communicate about their cars. The majority of members from the community communicate about their cars very specifically. Specific things can include the cars year, make, model, engine, EVERYTHING that has been done to the car, and your experiences. A lot of communication within this community is experience-based and problem-focused. For example: " I have a 2004 G35 Coupe with 140k miles. It started running rough at idle and threw a check engine light, which read a P0300 misfire code. I've replaced the spark plugs and coils, but the code is still there. The car is completely stock except for an air intake. Has anyone dealt with this before or able to point me in the right direction?"





Standard Forms of Communication

Online Forums / Social Media Posts -
Just installed an air intake on my 2018 Mustang GT, throttle response feels way better, but I'm getting a small whistle at higher RPM's, is this normal or should I check for leaks?

- YouTube / Video Walkthroughs - Title: How to change brake pads on a 04-08 Acura TL. Description: Step-by-step guide, tools required, torque specs included
- In Person Communication (Car shows, etc)
 - Q: "Your G35 sits so clean, what are you running for suspension?" A: "Thank you, I'm on BC coil overs, dropped about two inches. I had to roll the fenders so it doesn't rub the wheels. The hardest part was probably the rear, but it was worth it."



How do these examples support the community?

- A - Forums and social media let people ask questions, share their builds, and receive feedback from someone who may be more experienced or works on cars professionally for a living.
- B - Videos visually teach skills, which makes it much easier for beginners to learn repairs and mods. The videos in this community are actually very helpful, even if you're not directly involved with the community.
- C - In-person communication can build social connections, let people show off their cars, exchange advice with each other, and share firsthand experience or knowledge.

Outside Perspectives

- The automotive community is often represented in pop culture and non-academic media such as movies, TV shows, social media, and YouTube.
- In the majority of these portrayals, the community is glorified. Movies like Fast & Furious present car culture as thrilling and action-packed, mainly focusing on street racing and high-performance cars with hundreds of horsepower. However, in most of these movies, the slower and more technical side of what really goes into automotive work isn't really shown. Most of these movies or shows put a very big emphasis on speed or being the best racer.
- Social media and YouTube are also big factors as well. Most of the videos people make on their cars only show the best moments, which makes the work seem easier than it is. Chris Fix on YouTube is a great example; in his videos, everything goes so smoothly, and it's cut in parts to show you exactly what you need to do. However, what they did not show you was Chris Fix under his car, fighting with a bolt that is almost impossible to get for an hour and a half.

Citations / Sources

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